



PHOTO BY MANDAR DEODHAR

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METROPOLIS HEALTHCARE IS in a sweet spot. No sooner had it indicated that it was looking for strategic partners to grow its business, than it saw investors lining up to partner or buy a stake in the fast-growing diagnostics company.

Major companies across sectors are understood to have shown interest in buying stake in Metropolis. The list, sources say, includes names such as Apollo Hospitals along with the Adani Group, Amazon, Flipkart and Trivitron Healthcare, a medical technology firm.

What makes Metropolis attractive to investors? “The company is in good standing among the medical fraternity in India,” says Dr Arvind Lal, Chairman and Managing Director of Dr Lal PathLabs, a diagnostics and healthcare testing chain that competes with Metropolis. “On the whole, there is great interest in healthcare companies in India and Metropolis fits the bill eminently.”

Agrees Sriraam Rathi, Analyst-Healthcare & Pharmaceuticals at BNP Paribas India. “The company is well positioned to monetise industry tailwinds such as shift of the unorganised market to organised players and double-digit revenue growth with increasing demand for quality healthcare. Metropolis derives a large part of its revenue (42 per cent) from specialised tests, which is a differentiating factor from peers and helps generate better realisation,” he says.

Emailed queries to potential investors such as Apollo Hospitals, the Adani Group, Amazon and Flipkart did not any elicit any response, while Trivitron refused to comment.

Meanwhile, so strong has been investor interest that